

This project uses TouchDesigner to create a visualizer of a poem moving with water. By experimenting with the fluidity of water and its effect on the perception of words, I was able to create a visual that created harmony between the poem and the “water.” This project is more like one step in the direction towards a larger picture.

Our discussion in class about “What is Digital Nomadism?” Led to a series of thought processes about transience and its relationship with words and meaning. This project was used to evoke translation through waves, taking a very loose interpretation of nomadism and the ephemeral state of waves. In many ways, this project is not what I fully intended; instead I took this as an opportunity to play with TouchDesigner and understand the technology to create a precursor to a larger project. The program presented a unique opportunity to play around with the concept of digital nomadism and so for me, the first step was creating the playing field.

I took a lot of inspiration for the visuals of the project from the band Deftones and their song *Digital Bath*. I aimed to make this project look the way it feels to listen to the song, moving through a weightless domain with only words sharing that space. But the title of the song also connected the idea of water and the electromagnetic waves the technological devices emit. Beiguelman describes electronic communication devices as “new telecommunication spaces in urban areas [that] both create and respond to nomadic life patterns.” (Beiguelman, 2006) By using flowing water, I wanted to really embody this idea of words responding to waves and emphasizing this idea of moving with nomadic life.

For this project specifically, words themselves didn’t matter nearly as much as the overall visuals. I feel like this captures the essence of nomadic poetry where the words themselves take a backseat to the means of delivery. To me this only makes nomadic poetry more intriguing because technology is an ever-evolving entity and so the delivery is always changing as well.

Much like the nature of this style of poetry, I too want my project to take an evolutionary step in its next iteration. Having established an aesthetic, my focus can now shift to the methods I can use to better present my message.

Words themselves are transient in nature, moving from eyes to mouth to ears. To push my idea further I want to expand on this visualization of words “in passing.” Present for a moment only to disappear the next. In all honesty, I don’t have much to say about the piece itself. The current stage of this project is more reflective of a sketch than a fully realized concept. I want to expand on this idea of visual nomadism and its connection to poetry. Words translating over waves and reaching eyes, moving from one life unto the next.

References

Giselle Beiguelman, 2006. "Nomadic Poetry", New Media Poetics: **Contexts, Technotexts, and Theories**, Adalaide Morris, Thomas Swiss